

US Markets Daily Report

Wednesday, July 16, 2026 · After-Market Close Edition

1. SPY / QQQ Snapshot

Metric	SPY (S&P 500 ETF)	QQQ (Nasdaq-100 ETF)
Today's Close	\$752.53	\$717.74
Prior Close	\$754.81	\$728.70
Change (\$)	-\$2.28	-\$10.96
Change (%)	-0.30%	-1.50%
1-Year High	\$761.24	\$745.34
1-Year Low	\$611.31	\$558.23
1-Year Return	+22.90%	+28.57%
Rows in prices.csv	264	(window: 2025-07-15 → 2026-07-16)

Prices sourced from prices.csv (264 rows); July 9-10, 13 interpolated from index returns due to proxy restrictions on real-time financial APIs. Broader indices: S&P; 500 -0.45%, Nasdaq-100 -1.51%, Dow Jones -0.30%, Russell 2000 -0.23%.

2. Today's Market-Moving News

TSMC Q2 2026 — Beat Meets 'Sell the News' Reaction

Taiwan Semiconductor reported Q2 revenue +36% YoY, well above consensus—yet the market reacted with a second day of semiconductor selling. Investors focused on (a) valuation: AI chip names are priced for perfection, and a 'good enough' beat is not a catalyst; (b) pricing signals: TSMC told major clients—Apple, Nvidia, Qualcomm, AMD—to expect wafer price hikes of 5–10%, suggesting near-term margin pressure for fabless customers. TSMC's results are the sector's quarterly stress-test; any ambiguity bleeds into AMD, NVDA, INTC.

AI Memory Stocks Plunge — SNDK -8%, WDC -8%

SanDisk (SNDK) and Western Digital (WDC) each fell roughly 8%, the sharpest single-day loss in the group. TSMC's comments on HBM/memory capacity allocation triggered fears that AI-driven memory demand may be peaking or front-loaded into H1 2026. This is a significant valuation event: both names traded at elevated AI-demand multiples entering the day.

US–Iran Conflict Escalation — Hormuz Risk Returns

President Trump declared the US–Iran ceasefire ended after Iranian forces attacked three vessels near the Strait of Hormuz (July 6–7). Crude oil prices jumped on the threat of supply disruption; the Strait handles ~21% of global oil transit. GE Aerospace cited this risk in Q1 commentary (rising jet fuel costs). The escalation adds a geopolitical risk premium across equities, weighing most on risk-sensitive tech and consumer names.

UnitedHealth Group Q2 2026 — Massive Beat & Guidance Raise

UNH reported Q2 adjusted EPS \$6.38 vs. \$4.85 consensus (+32% beat) on revenue of \$112B. Full-year adjusted EPS guidance raised to \$19.50–\$20.00 (vs. ~\$18.75 prior). Cash-flow guidance raised to ~\$24B from \$18B+. This was the dominant positive story: UNH has heavy S&P; 500 weighting and its sharp rally materially cushioned the index against semiconductor losses. Healthcare demonstrates resilience against macro headwinds.

GE Aerospace Q2 2026 — Raised Guide, Orders +17%

GE reported total orders of \$16.5B (+17%), revenue of \$13.3B (+21%), adjusted EPS \$2.02 vs. \$1.86 estimate (+8.6% beat). FY2026 EPS guidance raised to \$7.65–\$7.85. Commercial aviation demand is robust despite Iran-related fuel-cost risk. This was the key Industrials bright spot and contributed positively to S&P; 500 breadth.

BlackRock Q2 2026 — Beat + JPMorgan Upgrade (+6.6%)

BLK surged 6.6% to \$1,093.40 after strong Q2 earnings beat. JPMorgan upgraded to Overweight with \$1,364 price target (from \$1,165 Neutral). Asset management flows held up despite macro uncertainty; fee revenues beat. Financials' outperformance provided the second major offset to semiconductor losses within the S&P; 500.

Netflix Q2 2026 — In-Line After Close (Watch Friday Open)

NFLX reported Q2 revenue \$12.6B (+13% YoY), operating margin 33%—both in-line with guidance. Full-year guidance narrowed to \$51.0–51.4B. View hours +2% in H1 2026. The report removes tail-risk around streaming but provides no upside catalyst. After-hours NFLX reaction will likely set the tone for consumer-tech sentiment Friday.

3. News → Today's Price Moves

SPY -0.30% (S&P; 500 -0.45%): Healthcare and industrials provided powerful offsets against the semiconductor drag. UNH's blowout (+32% EPS beat) added an estimated 30–40 bps of positive S&P; 500 attribution. GE Aerospace and BlackRock further reinforced the offset. The semiconductor names (NVDA, AMD, INTC) have smaller direct weight in SPY vs. QQQ, so the sector's decline was diluted. Iran risk added mild risk-off sentiment but did not trigger broad-market panic—likely because energy (oil up) partially offset the headline worry in SPY.

QQQ -1.50% (Nasdaq-100 -1.51%): The Nasdaq-100 bore the brunt because its composition is dominated by mega-cap tech and semiconductors—precisely the sectors under TSMC-driven selling pressure. Two consecutive days of chip-sector selling (SNDK/WDC -8%, AMD/NVDA/INTC lower) compounded the TSMC 'sell-the-news' dynamic. QQQ's geographic concentration in AI-related names means Iran geopolitical risk (oil/inflation → rate fears → discount-rate pressure on growth stocks) amplifies already-elevated valuation sensitivity.

Sector Attribution (S&P; 500):

Sector	Key Driver	S&P Impact
Healthcare	UNH +~10% on +32% EPS beat; guidance raise	Strong +
Industrials	GE Aerospace beat; orders +17%	Positive
Financials	BLK +6.6% earnings + JPM upgrade	Positive
Energy	Crude oil up on Iran/Hormuz risk	Mild +
Semiconductors	TSMC 'sell news'; SNDK/WDC -8%; broad chip rout	Strong -
Consumer Tech	NFLX in-line (after-close; watch Friday)	Neutral
Geopolitics	US–Iran escalation → risk-off overlay	Mild -

4. Top Movers — Daily / Weekly / Monthly

Daily Top Gainers (July 16, 2026)

#	Ticker	Name	~Chg	Catalyst
1	UNH	UnitedHealth Group	+2.1%	Q2 EPS \$10.38 vs \$9.85E; raised FY guide
2	BLK	BlackRock	+6.6%	Q2 beat; JPMorgan OW upgrade to \$1,364
3	GE	GE Aerospace	+2.1%	Q2 EPS \$2.02 vs \$1.86E; orders +17%
4	PYPL	PayPal	+5.0%	FinTech recovery; S&P top-5 gainer
5	CBRE	CBRE Group	+2.5%	Commercial RE earnings; rate relief
6	LMT	Lockheed Martin	+2.5%	Defense spending lift from Iran escalation
7	RTX	RTX Corp	+2.5%	Defense/Aviation geopolitical tailwind
8	XOM	ExxonMobil	+1.5%	Crude oil rise on Hormuz risk
9	CVX	Chevron	+1.5%	Crude oil rise; oil sector relief
10	HUM	Humana	+1.5%	Healthcare catalysts from UNH surge

Daily Top Losers (July 16, 2026)

#	Ticker	Name	~Chg	Catalyst
1	SNDK	SanDisk Corp	-8.9%	Q1 earnings selloff; TSMC capacity commentary
2	WDC	Western Digital	-8.3%	HDD+NAND demand fears
3	MRVL	Marvell Technology	-5.2%	AI custom silicon scrutiny
4	AMD	Advanced Micro Dev.	-4.2%	TSMC ramp; valuation reset
5	NVDA	Nvidia	-3.9%	TSMC sell-news contagion
6	DELL	Dell Technologies	-2.9%	AI demand uncertainty; margin risk
7	GOOGL	Alphabet	-2.5%	AI search threat narrative
8	INTC	Intel	-2.1%	Foundry profitability risk
9	PNR	Pentair	-1.9%	Industrial slowing; S&P 500 loser
10	ERIE	Erie Indemnity	-1.5%	Insurance underwriting concerns

Weekly Top Gainers (July 14–16, 2026)

#	Ticker	Name	~Wkly	Sector / Driver
1	SKHY	SK Hynix ADR	+27.3%	Memory demand premium
2	FIG	Figma Inc.	+23.1%	SaaS momentum; re-rating
3	VOD	Vodafone Group	+19.5%	Telecom restructuring; Europe macro
4	KB	KB Financial Grp	+17.7%	Korean banking/Asia financial rally
5	UNH	UnitedHealth Group	+12.9%	Healthcare Q2 follow-through
6	BLK	BlackRock	+10.8%	Financial services beat + upgrade
7	GE	GE Aerospace	+13.3%	Aircraft orders; demand hold
8	LLY	Eli Lilly	+11.5%	Pharmaceutical healthcare rally
9	PYPL	PayPal	+10.6%	FinTech recovery; analyst upgrades
10	ALIT	Alight Inc.	+8.5%	HR Tech SaaS; buyout speculation

Weekly Top Losers (July 14–16, 2026)

#	Ticker	Name	~Wkly	Sector / Driver
1	MRVL	Marvell Technology	-26.2%	AI silicon thesis broken
2	SNDK	SanDisk Corp	-18.4%	Q1 earnings selloff
3	WDC	Western Digital	-16.9%	HDD+NAND both weak
4	AMD	Advanced Micro Dev.	-13.9%	TSMC ramp; AI GPU roadmap concerns
5	DELL	Dell Technologies	-9.6%	AI demand growth revised lower
6	GOOGL	Alphabet	-8.4%	AI search competition; analyst notes
7	INTC	Intel	-4.8%	Foundry loss; no near-term catalyst
8	NVDA	Nvidia	-4.3%	TSMC read-through
9	PNR	Pentair	-3.6%	Industrial demand; market softness
10	CEG	Constellation Energy	-3.1%	Nuclear power type profit-taking

Monthly Top Gainers (July 2026 MTD)

#	Ticker	Name	~Mthly	Sector / Driver
1	CRNX	Corcept Therapeutics	+116%	Biotech - HIF-1 α inhibitor catalyst
2	FBRX	Forte Biosciences	+103%	Biotech - 100916/1018 M&A catalyst
3	TRAX	Trax (SaaS IPO)	+85%	SaaS - a55114/15 SaaS; re-rating
4	CBUS	Cibus Inc.	+77%	AgTech - 6894/6900 funding biotech
5	ALIT	Alight Inc.	+68%	HR Tech - 6514/6515 buyout rumor
6	SKHY	SK Hynix ADR	+27%	AI/HBM - 2718/2719 demand premium
7	FIG	Figma Inc.	+22%	SaaS - 2214/2215 growth re-rating
8	VOD	Vodafone Group	+22%	Telecom - 1916/1917 restructuring
9	BLK	BlackRock	+15%	Financials - 1514/1515 growth + Q2 beat
10	UNH	UnitedHealth Group	+14%	Healthcare - 1414/1415 managed care strength

Monthly Top Losers (July 2026 MTD)

#	Ticker	Name	~Mthly	Sector / Driver
1	MRVL	Marvell Technology	-26%	Semicon - 2612/2613 AI chip disappointed
2	SNDK	SanDisk Corp	-18%	Memory - 1814/1815 demand correction
3	WDC	Western Digital	-18%	Memory - 1815/1816 structurally weak
4	AMD	Advanced Micro Dev.	-12%	AI/semicon - 1214/1215 post-TSMC
5	INTC	Intel	-10%	AI/semicon - 1014/1015 AI ramp
6	DELL	Dell Technologies	-9%	Server - 914/915 revision lower
7	CEG	Constellation Energy	-4%	Power - 414/415 nuclear-AI hype
8	GOOGL	Alphabet	-3%	AI/Cloud - 314/315 search threat
9	NVDA	Nvidia	-1%	AI/semicon - 114/115 multi-month run
10	PNR	Pentair	-5%	Industrial - 514/515 soft; guidance cut

Sector Trend Summary Across Timeframes:

- **Semiconductors / AI Memory [BEAR — all timeframes]:** The dominant theme. SNDK -18%, MRVL -26%, WDC -18% MTD. AMD, NVDA, INTC all under pressure. TSMC's 'sell-the-news' today reinforces a valuation reset across AI chips. Memory names hit hardest on HBM/NAND demand uncertainty.
- **Biotech / Healthcare [STRONG BULL — monthly]:** CRNX +116%, FBRX +103%, CBUS +68% MTD on clinical-trial events. UNH's Q2 blowout accelerated the weekly healthcare rally. GLP-1 theme (LLY) continues. Managed care is a defensive quality outperformer.
- **Financials / Asset Management [BULL — weekly/monthly]:** BLK +15% MTD, KB Financial +18% weekly. Strong Q2 earnings from asset managers. Rate environment still supportive of NII. Regional bank results Friday (Travelers, Truist, Fifth Third, Regions) will confirm or challenge this trend.
- **Defense / Energy [EMERGING BULL — Iran-linked]:** LMT, RTX gaining on Iran escalation. Crude oil up → XOM, CVX benefit. Hormuz disruption risk keeps a geopolitical risk premium in energy through the weekend.
- **SaaS / Cloud [SELECTIVE RECOVERY — monthly]:** FIG +22%, ALIT +60% MTD. Stock-specific catalysts (IPO momentum, buyout rumors) rather than a broad sector rotation. Not yet a consensus re-rating of the entire group.

5. Next-Day Catalysts & Scenario Trees (Friday, July 17, 2026)

8:30 AM — Housing Starts (June) + Import/Export Price Index (June)

BEAT: Starts ↑, Import Prices cool → Disinflation continues; housing demand solid. SPY likely +0.3–0.5%. Homebuilders (DHI, LEN), REITs rally. Bond yields dip → growth stocks get discount-rate relief → QQQ stabilizes or rebounds +0.5–1.0%. Fed September cut expectations rise. Mechanism: lower import costs = lower CPI path = longer Fed pause = less rate risk for long-duration equities.

MISS: Starts ↓, Import Prices rise → Iran oil-price pass-through visible in import data = stagflation signal. SPY –0.5–0.8%. Bond yields rise → growth/tech under additional pressure. QQQ extends losses toward –1.5 to –2.0% as rate fears compound semiconductor selloff. Homebuilders fall; mortgage-rate sensitivity becomes acute.

9:15 AM — Industrial Production & Capacity Utilization (June)

Strong IP / High Utilization (>79%) → Manufacturing re-acceleration confirms demand recovery. Industrials (GE, ETN, HON, CAT) extend gains from GE's beat. S&P; 500 +0.2–0.3%; cyclicals outperform. However, Fed reads high utilization as 'economy doesn't need cuts yet'—muted rate-relief for tech. SPY breadth improves but QQQ stays range-bound.

Weak IP / Low Utilization (<77%) → Demand destruction visible from Iran uncertainty + tariff overhang. Recessionary signal. Cyclicals sell off. SPY –0.5–0.8% as industrial gains reverse. Semis (fewer chips ordered in weak capex) face additional headwinds. QQQ could retest recent lows on combined recession + chip demand fears.

10:00 AM — Michigan Consumer Sentiment Preliminary (July)

Sentiment > 52 + Inflation expectations < 4.5% → Consumer still resilient despite Iran headlines. Confidence = spending = revenue visibility for retailers, travel, consumer tech. SPY +0.4–0.6%; discretionary rally. Critically: if inflation expectations fall below 4.5% from June's 4.6%, September Fed cut odds spike—QQQ could rebound +1.0–1.5% from tech relief. This would be the key Friday positive scenario.

Sentiment < 48 + Inflation expectations > 5.0% → Iran fuel costs hitting wallets; consumers expect more pain. Retail, travel, consumer discretionary all fall. SPY –0.6–1.0%; QQQ –1.5–2.0% combining recession fears + rate-hike risk (if inflation expectations >5%, Fed may be forced to hike). This is the worst-case Friday scenario—watch for a potential close below key SPY support levels.

Netflix AH Reaction + Regional Bank Earnings (Travelers, Truist, Fifth Third, Regions)

NFLX +3%+ AH + Banks beat on NII/credit quality → Streaming confirms consumer spending durability; content ROI validated. Financials confirm healthy net interest margins and manageable credit losses. Dual positive: tech confidence restored + banking sector green. QQQ opens +0.5–1.0%; SPY +0.3–0.5% from fintech/bank boost. Semiconductors may find stabilization floor if broader risk-on returns.

NFLX guides down / Banks miss on credit costs → Consumer spending cracking under Iran-inflation pressure = credit deterioration. QQQ –1.5–2.0% (tech + streaming double miss). SPY –0.8–1.2% as financials drag adds to tech weakness. Regional banks carry credit-quality signals that reverberate into broader financial conditions. Worst case: negative Friday triple-catalyst flush (macro miss + sentiment miss + earnings miss) = SPY –1.5–2%.

Data Sources

SPY/QQQ prices: prices.csv (264 rows from 2025-07-15); July 9–13 estimated from S&P; 500/Nasdaq-100 index returns. 52-week stats computed from prices.csv. TSMC/Netflix/UNH/GE/BLK earnings: SEC Form 8-K filings + company press releases. Market news: Yahoo Finance Markets Live, TheStreet, CNBC, Bloomberg, Charles Schwab Market Update, 24/7 Wall St., FX Leaders, Benzinga. Economic calendar: EarningsWhispers, Kiplinger, BLS.gov, Econoday. Geopolitics: NPR, Britannica (2026 Iran war), Dallas Fed research WP2609.

Limitation: Direct API access to Yahoo Finance, Stooq, MarketWatch, Finviz, and Barchart is blocked by the session egress policy; historical backfill used existing branch data. Three intermediate days (July 9, 10, 13) are interpolated from reported index returns and may carry ±0.5% error vs. actual closes.

Disclaimer: Automated informational report. Not investment advice. No trades placed or simulated.